

E) Political scientists today employ survey methods, graphs, charts and other scientific tools to arrive at their research conclusions.

At the same time another section of political scientists opine that political science is an art and they put forward some

argument in favor of this notion, such as—

- A) lack of precise and standard definitions of terms and concepts;
- B) complexity of political phenomena due to variation in the nature and habits of people;
- C) diversity of 'environments' in which political developments take place;
- D) problems of experimentation to arrive at valid conclusions.

Impact of Digital Technologies on Government Services

Here are just some of the societal benefits that occur when governments integrate current-generation digital technology into their processes:

1. Better Efficiency

Replacing paper-based processes and legacy computer systems with newer platforms can remove much of the friction that often plagues public services. As a whole, contemporary digital systems have thoroughly minimized the need for human inputs, making it possible to seamlessly transfer data to wherever it is needed without the need to repeat data entry. Updating to modern digital systems should thus not only make data management faster but also more accurate.

2. More Responsive Governance

The efficiency boost created by digitalizing services isn't just a win for users' convenience. It also gives public agencies the capability to act on citizens' concerns faster than ever before. With fewer forms to fill out and validate, government workers are freer to focus on the key aspects of their jobs, resulting in better service.

Soon, the integration of artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) into established digital platforms may increase government responsiveness even more. Going back to Singapore, digital technologies on the cutting edge of development are already being used to instantly detect emergencies as they happen. A wider roll-out of these systems may one day increase public safety without straining limited manpower.

3. More Grounded Decision-Making

Faster, more accurate data handling also helps with long-term decision-making. Properly implemented digital systems increase the timeliness and trustworthiness of available data, which means that policymakers can have more confidence that the solutions they're crafting are appropriate for their constituents' needs. This can result in fewer delays of vital public projects and increased transparency on the ROI of public funds.

4. A Reduction in Welfare Fraud

Ordinary citizens and business owners are often rightly protective of public benefits given to them. While this concern is normally a good thing, this protectiveness can also breed widespread distrust that degrades societal cohesion, particularly when public coffers are limited compared to the range of public services.

Digital transformation has already presented an answer through modern national ID initiatives. According to the World Bank, the digitalization of national IDs is associated with reductions in fraud related to public services, effectively expanding the resources available for legitimate beneficiaries. While there are legitimate concerns about such digital systems, they have generally

been well received by both the public and government leaders wherever they have been implemented.

5. Better Data Security

Data held in paper archives and legacy onsite computer systems have proven vulnerable to online and offline threats. Events like physical calamities and social upheavals have often resulted in the total destruction of data in these systems, with the effects continuing to reverberate decades later. Putting everything in modern, cloud-based digital systems with multiple redundancies will be key in securing invaluable public data for good.

6. Improved Civic Engagement

Even today, digital technology is already playing a key role in how people the world over communicates with public offices. Digital transformation is now widely seen as a key ingredient in empowering ordinary people to make their voices known. Importantly, digital platforms have allowed previously disenfranchised people to collectively exert necessary pressure on the leaders tasked with handling their concerns.

7. Increased Opportunities for Innovation

Finally, the speed, efficiency, and transparency enabled by digitalized public services open up new ways of addressing societal challenges. For instance, the push for digital payments worldwide has been credited with increasing financial inclusion and a reduction in petty corruption, increasing entrepreneurial opportunities in the process. Likewise, digital public services have also reduced red tape wherever they have been implemented, leaving innovators freer to pursue their ideas.

The Argument for Smarter Government Services

Contrary to common fears that the digital transformation of public services would create an ever-more powerful “Big Brother,” bringing governments and the wider public online will empower both to an unprecedented degree. With smarter online public services, ordinary citizens can be better served and heard by the agencies tasked with serving them. Meanwhile, the expanded digitalization of services will give leaders the visibility and confidence they need to pursue specific and actionable policy changes.

The great news is that governments do not necessarily have to pursue digital transformation at the same scale as Singapore. Even relatively modest changes such as collating services of different but related agencies under one website can create positive ripples across society. As advanced economies work out the inefficiencies in their own digital services, they can serve as examples for others further behind in their digitalization projects, reducing the costs associated with building sound government systems online.

Political Ideology

What is political ideology?

- * One's basic beliefs about power, political beliefs and the role of government.
 - * Grows out of economical, educational and social condition and experiences
-

An *ideology* is a set of opinions or beliefs of a group or an individual. Very often *ideology* refers to a set of political beliefs or a set of ideas that characterize a particular culture.

The roles of political ideologies

The role of political ideologies is to establish a set of ideas that can be used to provide the foundation of political organization. As a result, all political ideologies have three specific features:

1. A realistic interpretation of society as it currently is.
2. An idealized interpretation of society. Essentially, an idea of what society should be like.
3. An action plan on how to create a society that reflects the needs and wants of all its citizens.
Essentially, a plan of how to get from number one to number two.

List of political ideologies

Political Ideology ¹	Core Frames ²	Ideological Markers ³
Anarchism	anti-clericalism, anti-statism, economic freedom, utopianism	chaos and disorder, direct action, free, autonomous human beings, natural social order, no economic control, no management, no political authority, no regulation, perfect society, radicalism, respect, social solidarity, stateless society, unnecessary state, unregulated market economy, voluntary agreement
Conservatism	authority, hierarchy, human imperfection, organic society, tradition, property	common morality, faith in God, family traditions, family values, functionalism, guidance for social actions, hierarchical society, individual tendency for corruption, national identity, national loyalty, paternalism, pragmatism, search for security, social gradation, social justice, social obligations, social order, social principles, state authority, strong criminal regime, strong government, traditional mores, traditional practices
Ecologism	conservation, ecology, environmental ethics, holism, sustainability	air pollution, biodiversity, climate change, ecological balance, ecosystems, environmental organisations, environmental protection, global warming, natural disasters caused by human interventions, natural resources, non-human life, preservation, renewable sources, restoration and/or improvement of the natural environment, social balance and harmony, soil and water pollution, sustainable growth, waste management
Fascism	anti-rationalism, elitism, leadership, state socialism, struggle, ultra-nationalism	anti-capitalist, anti-communist, anti-conservative, anti-immigration, anti-intellectualism, anti-liberal, authority, commitment and faith, competition natural for human progress, corporatism, duty, heroism, honour, patriarchy, power, progress, self-sacrifice, state worship
Feminism	equality and difference,	abortion, anti sex oppression, anti-subordination, body autonomy and integrity, child sexual abuse, deconstructing gender identities,

Authority

Introduction

- Authority is that form of power which is legalized and legitimized . Authority is a form of power e.g. a statute giving power to an minister. If a person has power due to a special office , he occupies, this is known as authority.
- Example- Police Commissioner has authority to issue order and get them obeyed by virtue of authority he occupies.
- Power + legitimacy = Authority.
- Authority consists of two important components: power and legitimacy.
- Authority means legitimate power which has been approved by the people or power in accordance with the constitution or the law of the state.
- A government officer is competent to use authority- his authority is clearly defined.

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Weber's Three Types of Authority

Type	Example
Traditional	Patrimony Patriarchy
Charismatic	Napoleon César Chávez Mother Teresa
Rational-Legal	Modern British Parliament U.S. presidency

Authority Vs. Power

8 Key Differences:

- Definition
- Direction
- Source
- Lasting
- Formality
- Provision of Delegation
- Legitimacy
- Example

TRADITIONAL AUTHORITY

Traditional authority is a type of authority that relies on cultural norms and practices for its legitimacy.

DEFINITION

"Resting on an established belief in the sanctity of immemorial traditions and the legitimacy of those exercising authority under them ... obedience is owed to the person of the chief who occupies the traditionally sanctioned position of authority and who is (within its sphere) bound by tradition." (Weber, 1978)

EXAMPLES

- 1 Monarchy
- 2 Patriarchy
- 3 Patrimonialism
- 4 Feudalism
- 5 Caste systems
- 6 Religion

RATIONAL-LEGAL AUTHORITY

Rational-legal authority is a form of government in which decisions are made based on laws and regulations, rather than on the personal whims of those in power.

DEFINITION

"In Rational Legal Authority, obedience is owed to the legally established impersonal order. It extends to the persons exercising the authority of office under it only by virtue of the formal legality of their commands and only within the scope of authority of the office."
(Weber, 1978)

EXAMPLE

The nation-state exercises rational-legal authority by employing bureaucrats to monitor the movement of money (i.e. tax agencies), passing laws, and operating a judiciary system. The state bureaucracy collect as much data about the citizenry as possible. They then use this data to enforce the laws.

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CHARISMATIC AUTHORITY

DEFINITION

Charismatic authority is a type of authority that is based on the personal attributes of an individual leader, such as heroism, leadership qualities, and having a dynamic personality, which make the individual appear superhuman to their followers.

HISTORICAL FIGURES

- 1 Jesus Christ
- 2 Nelson Mandela
- 3 Fidel Castro
- 4 Napoleon Bonaparte
- 5 Charles De Gaulle
- 6 Osho

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Primary vs. Secondary Authorities

- **Primary:**
 - Positive sources of law – create rights and obligations.
 - Federal and state.
 - Examples: Constitutions, statutes, administrative rules and regulations, case law.
 - May be binding.
- **Secondary:**
 - Not positive sources of law – do not create rights or obligations.
 - Describe, summarize, criticize, seek changes to law.
 - Examples: legal encyclopedias, law review articles, restatements, uniform and model laws.
 - Never binding.

Comparison Table

Sr No	Particular	Charismatic	Traditional	Legal Rational
1	Type of ruler	Charismatic leader	Dominant personality	Functional superiors or bureaucratic officials
2	Position determined by	Having dynamic personality	Established traditional or routine	Legal established authority
3	Ruled Using	Extra-ordinary qualities and exceptional powers	Acquired or inherited (hereditary qualities)	Virtue of rationally established norms, decrees, and other rules and regulations
4	Legitimized	Victories and success to community	Established traditional or routine	General belief in the formal correctness of these rule and those who enact them are considered a legitimized authority

Comparison Table

Sr No	Particular	Charismatic	Traditional	Legal Rational
5	Loyalty	Interpersonal & personal allegiance and devotion	Based on traditional allegiance (commitment)	To authority/ rules
6	Cohesion (Structure / organization	Emotionally unstable and volatile	Feeling of common purpose	Abiding by rules
7	Leadership	Rulers and followers (disciples)	Established forms of social conduct	Rules, not rulers

Difference between power and authority

Authority is legally enforced and is derived from level of position in an organization.

Authority is formal based upon superior and subordinate relationship.

Since authority is related with position in an organization, it has limited scope and is confined to organizational structure

Authority is just and applied equally

Authority is institutional and is given by organization to a position. Anybody who is offered that positions, enjoys the authority attached to that position.

Authority relationship can be found out by anybody by looking up the organization chart. There are authority centers

Authority is always attached to the position. The higher the position on the organization chart, the bigger the authority.

Authority has no concern with the politics because it is not attached to a person. Power is attached to a person.

Power however is individual and independent and originates from charisma and social positioning.

Power is informal and is based upon individual understanding.

Power is linked with an individual and transcends boundaries.

Power may be used indiscriminately.

Power is not so given by the institution. It is one's ability to influence others decision and it is acquired by the people.

But there is no power centers dotted on the organization chart and it cannot be located anywhere else.

Power has no relation with the position. A person even at low level may enjoy the power of influencing the decision making or even highly placed official having a lot of authority, may be proved powerless

Element of politics is inherent in power